

Ross Dahlke

Assistant Professor

University of Wisconsin–Madison, SJMC

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Academic Appointments

University of Wisconsin–Madison

Assistant Professor

Madison, WI

2025–Present

- School of Journalism and Mass Communication
- Affiliate, Elections Research Center

Education

Stanford University

PhD, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2022–2024

- Dissertation: *The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Politics, News, and Misinformation in Personal Messaging Applications*
- Advisor: Jeffrey T. Hancock. Committee: Jennifer Pan, Byron Reeves, Matthew Gentzkow, Michael Bernstein (chair)
- Data Science Scholar, Stanford Data Science Program
- Knight–Hennessy Scholar

Stanford University

MA, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2020–2022

- Knight–Hennessy Scholar

University of Wisconsin–Madison

JBA, Comprehensive Honors

Journalism & Mass Communication · Political Science

Madison, WI

2014–2018

- Theodore Herfurth Award for top undergraduate male student
- College of Letters & Science Dean's Prize (awarded to three students)

Research

Publications

** indicates equal authorship*

13. Dahlke, R., Yang, Y., Lukito, J., Greenfield, J., Chen, B., Brown, M. A., & Lewis, R. (2026). Style and substance on The Alex Jones Show predict InfoWars sales: a multi-modal analysis of a media empire. *Information, Communication & Society*, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2026.2642851>
12. Kim, Y. M., Dahlke, R., Song, H., & Heinrich, R. (2026). Targeted digital voter suppression efforts likely decrease voter turnout. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(5), e2519944123. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2519944123>
11. Lee, A. Y., Stevic, A., Walker-Keleher, G., Chen, C., Charity, E., Dahlke, R., & Hancock, J. (2026). Going light: The effects of minimal mobile phone adoption on young adults' well-being depend on

motivation. *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791723>

Coverage · The New York Times

10. Dahlke, R., & Hancock, J. (2025). Untrustworthy website exposure and election beliefs: Selective exposure and ideological asymmetry. *Journal of Online Trust and Safety*, 3(1). <https://doi.org/10.54501/jots.v3i1.250>
9. Dahlke, R., Kumar, D., Durumeric, Z., & Hancock, J. T. (2025). Quantifying the Systematic Bias in the Accessibility and Inaccessibility of Web Scraping Content From URL-Logged Web-Browsing Digital Trace Data. *Social Science Computer Review*, 43(5), 1071–1086. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393231218214>
8. Dahlke*, R., Tu*, F., Wang*, Y.-C., Lu, Y., Engeda, B. W., & Hancock, J. T. (2025). Contextualizing Misinformation: A User-Centric Approach to Linguistic and Topical Patterns in News Consumption. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 9(CSCW1), 1–40. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757571>
7. Lukito, J., Macdonald, M., Chen, B., Brown, M. A., Prochaska, S., Yang, Y., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., Zhong, W., Dahlke, R., & Borah, P. (2025). Candidates Be Posting: Multi-Platform Strategies and Partisan Preferences in the 2022 US Midterm Elections. *Social Media+ Society*, 11(2), 20563051251337541. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051251337541>
6. Chen, B., Borah, P., Dahlke, R., & Lukito, J. (2024). Battle for Inbox and Bucks: Comparing Email Fundraising Strategies of Donald Trump and Joe Biden in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2024.012>
5. Dahlke, R., & Pan, J. (2024). January 6 Arrests and Media Coverage Do Not Remobilize Conservatives on Social Media. *Proceedings of the National Academies of Sciences*. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2401239121>
4. Dahlke, R., & Zhang, Y. (2024). Surviving or thriving political defeat on social media: a temporal analysis of how electoral loss exacerbates the gender gap in political expression. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1), zmad051. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcmc/zmad051>
3. Lukito, J., Greenfield, J., Yang, Y., Dahlke, R., Brown, M. A., Lewis, R., & Chen, B. (2024). Audio-as-data tools: Replicating computational data processing. *Media and Communication*, 12. <https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.7851>
2. Moore*, R. C., Dahlke*, R., Forberg, P. L., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). The Private Life of QAnon: A Mixed Methods Investigation of Americans' Exposure to QAnon Content on the Web. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 8(CSCW2), 1–34. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3687057>
1. Moore*, R. C., Dahlke*, R., & Hancock, J. T. (2023). Exposure to untrustworthy websites in the 2020 US election. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1096–1105. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-023-01564-2>

Coverage · The New York Times, World Economic Forum, Minnesota Star Tribune, The Daily Beast

Papers Under Review

* indicates equal authorship

8. Dahlke, R., Lee, A. Y., Stevic, A., Walker-Keleher, G., Chen, C. Q.-A., Charity, E., & Hancock, J. T. (2026). Replacing Smartphones With Minimal Mobile Phones Improves College Students' Trust in News but Not News-Finds-Me Perceptions. *Under Review*.

7. Dahlke, R., Mine, N., Zhao, H., Huang, Y., & Shah, D. (2026). Electoral Prediction Markets: A Quantitative Description of Online Political Betting Markets. *Under Review*.
6. Dahlke, R., Moore, R., Adib-Azpeitia, D., Ugander, J., & Hancock, J. (2026). Multi-Platform Referrers of Misinformation: A Comparative Ablation Study of Misinformation Visits Referred by Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Reddit, YouTube, Snapchat, and TikTok. *Conditionally Accepted at Political Communication*.
5. Dahlke*, R., Moore*, R., Bengani, P., & Hancock, J. (2026). The Consumption of Pink Slime Journalism: Who, What, When, Where, and Why? *Forthcoming at Digital Journalism*. <https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/3bwz6>
Award · Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division of the International Communication Association 2024 Conference
Coverage · Northwestern Local News Initiative, The Boston Globe
4. Dahlke*, R., Moore*, R. C., & Hancock, J. T. (2026). Exposure to (AI-generated) untrustworthy websites in the 2024 US election. *Revise & Resubmit at Nature Communications*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg_v1
3. Kwon, H., Jiang, X., & Dahlke, R. (2026). Do Politicians' Strategic Facial Expressions Drive Resonant Moments on Social Media? Computational Analysis of the 2024 U.S. Presidential Debate Using Multimodal Large Language Models. *Revise & Resubmit at International Journal of Communication*.
2. Lukito, J., Zhang, Y., Pruden, M., Prochaska, S., Chen, B., Zhong, W., Brown, M., Dahlke, R., Suk, J., Greenfield, J., & Borah, P. (2026). Cross-Platformization: How U.S. Right-Leaning Media Curate Their Posts on Twitter and Truth Social. *Revise & Resubmit at New Media and Society*.
1. Dahlke, R., & Hancock, J. (2025). The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Quantifying Political Computer-Mediated Communication in Personal Messaging. *Under Review*. <https://osf.io/6cpv8/>

Public Pre-Prints & Reports

1. Lukito, J., Brown, M. A., Dahlke, R., Suk, J., Yang, Y., Zhang, Y., Chen, B., Kim, S. J., & Soorholtz, K. (2023). The state of digital media data research, 2023. *Social Science Research Council*. <http://dx.doi.org/10.26153/tsw/46177>

Invited Talks & Guest Lectures

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| The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Political Content and Sources in Personal Messaging | <i>March 2026</i> |
| Communication and Media Colloquium · University of Iowa | |
| Exploring Ethical Use of AI and Computational Methods in Organizational Research | <i>October 2025</i> |
| Organizational Communication Mini Conference 2025 · University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign | |
| Understanding Election Manipulation with Data Science | <i>November 2024</i> |
| Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University | |
| Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election | <i>November 2023</i> |
| Communication 124/224: Truth, Trust & Technology · Stanford University | |

Untrustworthy Website Exposure and Effects	November 2023
Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University	
Single Case Research Methodology and Visualization	September 2023
University of Minnesota–Twin Cities	
Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election	May 2022
Cyber Policy Center, Freeman Spogli Institute · Stanford University	

Awards & Funding

Collaborative Summer Research Initiative (50% Graduate Project Assistantship)	2025
	\$10,700
University of Wisconsin–Madison Elections Research Center	
Top Reviewer Award, 2023	2024
Social Science Computer Review	
Non-Western Countries Expanding Online Trust & Safety Research Grant	2024
	\$15,000
Stanford Cyber Policy Center	
Data Science Scholar	2023
	~\$93,000
Stanford University Data Science	
Stanford EST (Ethics, Society, and Technology) Research Grant	2023
	\$5,000
Stanford University	
Stanford PACS (Philanthropy and Civil Society) Research Grant	2023
	\$3,000
Stanford University	
Graduate Student Researcher	2023
Office of Army Research & DoD Multidisciplinary University Research Initiative (MURI): Multi-Modal Network Information Dynamics Group	
Knight–Hennessy Scholarship	2020
	~\$280,000
Stanford University	

Teaching

Courses	
JOURN 677 – Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization	Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026
University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor	

JOURN 818 – Computational Approaches for Communication Research	<i>Fall 2025</i>
University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor	
Communication 124/224 – Truth, Trust & Technology	<i>Spring 2024</i>
Stanford University · Teaching Assistant	
Communication 172/272 – Media Psychology	<i>Winter 2023</i>
Stanford University · Teaching Assistant	
Inter-LS 250 – Undergraduate Research Experience	<i>2016–2018</i>
University of Wisconsin–Madison · Teaching Fellow	
Advising	
<i>PhD Advising</i>	
Haotian (Barry) Zhao	
PhD, Journalism & Mass Communication · Advisor	
Yanshu (Sybil) Wang	
PhD, Journalism & Mass Communication · Advisor	
<i>Research MA Advising</i>	
Yingqi (Vicky) Huang	
MA, Journalism & Mass Communication · Advisor	
<i>Directed Study</i>	
Yanshu (Sybil) Wang	<i>Spring 2026</i>
Directed Study	
Yanshu (Sybil) Wang	<i>Fall 2025</i>
Directed Study	
Professional Development	
Madison Teaching and Learning Excellence	<i>August 2025–May 2026</i>
Center for Teaching, Learning, and Mentoring · University of Wisconsin–Madison	
The Discussion Project	<i>August 2025</i>
Wisconsin Center for Education Research · University of Wisconsin–Madison	
Wisconsin Idea Seminar	<i>May 2025</i>
Office of the Provost · University of Wisconsin–Madison	

Service

School of Journalism and Mass Communication

Graduate Committee

January 2025–Present

Member

Disciplinary Service

International Journal of Press + Politics

January 2025–Present

Data Editor

Media & Democracy Data Cooperative (MDDC)

September 2020–Present

Research Lead, Executive Board Member · <https://mddatacoop.org/>

International Communication Association Hackathon

June 2023–June 2024

Co-Organizer · <https://www.hackingcommsci.org/>

Digital Data Conference (D2C)

December 2021–April 2022

Co-Organizer · <https://mediaengagement.org/event/digital-data-conference/>

Peer Reviewer

- AI and Ethics
- Communication Methods and Measures
- Computational Communication Research
- HKS Misinformation Review
- Human Communication Research
- Information Processing and Management
- International Journal of Communication
- International Journal of Public Opinion Research
- Journal of Online Trust and Safety
- Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media
- Mass Communication & Society
- New Media & Society
- Political Communication
- Science Advances
- Social Science Computer Review
- Virtual Reality

Professional Experience

Ovative Group

Minneapolis, MN

Data Scientist

2018–2020

- Full-stack data scientist in R, Python, and SQL, building tools to measure causal effects of digital media exposure on online and offline sales
- Clients included UnitedHealth Group, Facebook Marketplace, and Coach Bags

Self-Employed

Madison, WI

Political Data Consultant

2015–2024

- Built predictive voter models for statewide, judicial, and municipal campaigns using survey and voter-contact data in R and Python
- Models informed budget allocation, advertising audience prioritization, and strategic campaign decisions